

1. Datasette 1.0a39 and 0.65.4 security releases

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-11T03:27:16+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/11/datasette-security/>

Datasette 1.0a39 and 0.65.4 security releases Today we're releasing two new security patch versions of Datasette: 1.0a39 and 0.65.4 - one for the current alpha series and one for the stable 0.65.x family. These are security fixes which you should apply if you are running a Datasette instance on the public web - in particular if that instance mixes both public and private tables. Following issues reported by Sevban Dönmez , Alex Garcia and I ran an extensive audit of Datasette using Claude Fable 5.1, GPT-5.6, and GPT-6 Astra. We then spent almost a week collaborating on and reviewing the fixes. They helped find some very subtle bugs. We'll be incorporating security audits by frontier models into all of our development work going forward. Alex came up with a way of splitting the work which I found extremely productive: Alex Garcia and I worked together running and then responding to the audit, working in a shared private repository. For most of the issues we split the work: one of us would create the automated tests highlighting the issue, then the other would implement the fix. This ensured that two separate humans had eyes on each of the issues, in addition to our coding agents ru...

2. Any Nix package, live in your browser

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-10T23:44:15+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/10/trynix/>

Any Nix package, live in your browser Farid Zakaria calls this his " magnum opus of Nix work", and I can see why. trynix.dev provides a qemu-wasm powered x86_64 Linux virtual machine running entirely in your browser through WebAssembly. That VM can then be booted with any Nix package from the past 13 years. They are URL addressable, so you can navigate to this page: <https://trynix.dev/?pkg=python3%403.6.2> Then click "Load" and get an interactive shell against a virtual machine running Python 3.6.2 from 2017. Farid is building all sorts of neat things on top of this. One recent example: Review a pull request by booting it introduces trynix-preview , described like this: GitHub action that comments a link on a pull request which lets you boot the PR's build in the browser using <https://trynix.dev> . No servers, just browsers. Via Lobste.rs Tags: code-review , linux , webassembly , github-actions

3. Native is now the future of mobile at Shopify

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-10T21:11:15+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/10/shopify-react-native/>

Native is now the future of mobile at Shopify Shopify are moving from React Native back to separate Swift and Kotlin codebases for their native apps, for the exact reason you would expect: We decided to switch from native to React Native in 2020 for three reasons: Stop building the same features twice Allow developers to work across the stack Spend less time chasing feature parity and more time shipping value [...] Native still means building and maintaining software on two platforms, that cost has not disappeared. What changed is that agents can now do enough of the implementation, translation, testing, and review work that it's no longer the deciding factor it was in 2020. It's a well-written post, which gives full credit to React Native as a great platform for the six years they were using it. Shopify are the maintainers of three significant React Native libraries: react-native-skia , flash-list , and restyle . The first two are finding new homes; the third "has a smaller user base than our other libraries" and will be archived at the end of 2026. Via Hacker News Tags: android , mobile , open-source , ios , ai , react , generative-ai , llms , ai-assisted-search , coding-agents...

4. Apple's OS 27 Updates Will Be Released on Monday, 14 September

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-10T20:15:52Z

Link:

<https://9to5mac.com/2026/09/09/apple-confirms-macos-27-golden-gate-launch-date-september-14/>
9to5 Mac has the iOS 27 release notes too. I haven't spent much time using Golden Gate, but I've been using iOS 27 full-time ever since WWDC. It's in excellent shape for a .0 release. Now I need to think about how long I want to still hang onto MacOS 15 Sequoia on my main Mac. I'll probably skip 27.0 and wait for 27.1, but maybe I'll bite the bullet and upgrade when a 27.0.1 update comes out. ?

5. Joanna Stern on the iPhone Duo

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-10T17:29:30Z

Link: <https://youtu.be/VNzI-q0EGfg>

One thing I learned from this video is that I'm way, way too careful when playing with the hands-on area demo units. I handle them like museum pieces; Stern treats them like hot dog buns. ?

6. Trump Administration Launches Rip-Off Video Games at Arcade.gov

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-06T17:51:09Z

Link: <https://x.com/WhiteHouse/status/2095615734567100766>

A handful of Temu-style knockoffs of games like Flappy Bird, Snake (that's the one where you round up border-crossing migrants), and, most notably, Tetris (the one where you build a wall to keep border-crossing migrants out) the copyright to which is held by the notoriously litigious The Tetris Company, which tweeted : At Tetris we believe in the power of connection and bringing people together, not dividing them. To our fans everywhere: we love you, we see you, and we're grateful to have you in our community. P.S. The Tetris Company was not involved in the creation of Build the Wall. P.P.S. We take copyright infringement very seriously. Whatever you think of these games, just like with the rebranding of Lake Ontario, Trump Arcade shows American voters that this administration is focused on their problems and concerns. ?

7. Bayesian OCR

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 10 Sep 2026 12:32:31 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/09/10/bayesian-ocr/>

The Greek letter β (beta) and the German letter ß (eszett) look similar, especially in some fonts. Now suppose an OCR program sees some character that could be a beta or could be an eszett. It could calculate some kind of distance between the pixel pattern of the character and the pixel patterns of [β] The post Bayesian OCR first appeared on John D. Cook .

8. Put an AV test at the start of your slides

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Thu, 10 Sep 2026 11:34:10 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/09/put-an-av-test-at-the-start-of-your-slides/>

For years, I've had a test-card at the start of my slides. Before I start my talk, I can immediately see if the aspect ratio is wrong, colours are off, or any other visual issues with the presentation. A few years ago I was invited to give a talk and was assured that the venue was set up for audio as well as video. I dutifully filled my slides with demo videos containing sound. None of?

9. AI Is Breaking This Thing We Call Trust

Source: Terrible Software | Published: Thu, 10 Sep 2026 14:18:06 +0000

Link: <https://terriblesoftware.org/2026/09/10/ai-is-breaking-this-thing-we-call-trust/>

AI-generated work can look finished without being understood. That uncertainty erodes trust, slows reviews, and leaves colleagues doing the missing work.

10. Package Manager Trends

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-09-10T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/09/10/package-manager-trends.html>

I'm on holiday this week, so I'm phoning it in and doing a roundup of the trends I've seen across sixteen weeks of This Week in Package Management . Those posts are built from about

eighty RSS feeds and whatever I've boosted on Mastodon. The short version: the same defensive features keep shipping in tool after tool, and the same three bug classes keep getting fixed. Features Release-age cooldowns appeared in more tools than any other feature: Deno 2.8 added min-release-age to its .npmrc handling in May, and by early September equivalent gates had shipped in Bundler , npm , Yarn , mise , Hex , Mamba , and Cargo via the nightly -Zmin-publish-age flag. Dependabot made a three-day cooldown its unconditional default in August. The interaction between cooldowns and security updates recurred as a special case: Dependabot, Renovate and Hex each added a way to lift the gate when an advisory is published against the held-back version. The Nx compromise postmortem noted an old pnpm ignoring minimum-release-age , and both npm 12 and pnpm 12 now error on unrecognised config keys rather than skip them. Install-script blocking became the default in the JavaScript tools. npm 12 blocks lifecycle...

11. Extending Raschka's GPT-2: an MoE trained from scratch on an RTX 3090

Source: Giles' blog | Published: Thu, 10 Sep 2026 18:45:00 +0000

Link: <https://www.gilesthomas.com/2026/09/gpt-2-to-moe>

Mixture-of-experts models are really nifty. You get inference speed close to a small model's, with a lot of the smarts and knowledge of a large one. While they use as much memory as an equivalently-sized dense (non-MoE) model, they're much faster. The frontier labs don't publish their architectures, but Claude and ChatGPT are widely rumoured to be MoEs these days -- and certainly many large open-weights models like DeepSeek and Kimi K3 are. In this post, I'll show you how I added MoE support to the GPT-2-style code from Sebastian Raschka 's book " Build a Large Language Model (from Scratch) ", then used that to train a 446M-parameter model with 220M active parameters from scratch on my RTX 3090 -- essentially, GPT-2 small with 6 experts, 2 active per token. I wanted to understand how MoEs work, and as always, felt that the best way to do that is to build one (and then to write it up like this). Hopefully because it's all fresh in my mind as I write this, I should be able to explain things clearly for others who've finished Raschka's book. The training run took just less than eight days, and the resulting model got a better loss on my test set than any of the other models I've trai...

12. An Ode to Links

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Thu, 10 Sep 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/ode-to-links/>

A URL is a technical thing: a hostname, a path, a port, an origin, some query parameters, etc. But a link is a cultural thing: an invitation, a citation, a gift, a shortcut, a connection. All from a simple idea: here's a thing that points to another thing, off you go! We've built an entire culture around links. Just look at the language we use for them: "Drop me a link." "Send me the link." "Got a link?" "Link in bio." "Link in the description." "Here's the link." "Don't click that link." "Sorry, wrong link." Or even just, "Link?" Our language spans the spectrum of meaning, from one end to the other: We save links. We lose links. We share links. We hide links. We send links. We receive links. We collect links. We discard links. We open links. We close links. We add links. We remove links. We make links. We break links. We shorten links. We expand links. We follow links. We ignore links. We click links. We don't click links. We link in. We link out. We make links. Links make the web. The web makes Us. Reply via: Email • Mastodon • Bluesky

13. Automatic Minus Matt

Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-09-10T05:29:30Z

Link: <https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17444080/matt-mullenweg-automatic-leave-absence>

Matt Mullenweg takes an involuntary leave of absence from Automattic, the company behind WordPress. Let's hope he uses his time away thoughtfully.